Name: ..... Due: **Next Class / Friday**

C3 Direct to Tape Mono Recordings HW 2 – Miles Davis 'So What' (Kind of Blue)

Artist: Miles Davis (Columbia 30th Street Studio, NYC, 1959, Engineer: Fred Plaut)
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ylXk1LBvIqU

1. In 1959, Miles Davis recorded "Kind of Blue" live in Columbia's cavernous 30th Street Studio. Identify the acoustic positioning and room placement of the ensemble. (3)

Instrument	Acoustic Room Placement / Direction
Trumpet (Miles Davis)	Front Centre / Direct on Ribbon Mic
Tenor Sax (John Coltrane)	
Upright Bass (Paul Chambers)	
Piano (Bill Evans)	

2. What call-and-response bass motif opens the track between 0'00" and 0'32"? (1)

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3. What year was "Kind of Blue" recorded, and state ONE acoustic feature of the recording environment that distinguishes Columbia 30th Street Studio from modern dry booths? (2)

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4. During the 1950s direct-to-tape era, tape ran at 15 inches per second (ips). Explain the sonic advantages of higher tape speed (15 ips vs 7.5 ips) regarding frequency response, dynamic range, and tape hiss. (4)

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5. Without isolation booths or overdubbing, how did 1950s recording engineers control "acoustic bleed" (spill) between loud horns and quiet instruments like the upright bass? (4)

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6. Describe how you would close-mic an acoustic jazz trumpet in a modern studio to capture warmth while avoiding harsh high-frequency transients: (4)

Choice of Microphone (Ribbon vs Dynamic) & Polar Pattern (2)
Microphone: Polar Pattern:
Positioning, On-Axis vs Off-Axis Angle & Distance (2)

Total:	**/18**